



Which One Does Not Belong?

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children find the one object in a group that does not share the others' attribute. Deciding what matters (here, shape) and ignoring the rest is abstraction — a computational-thinking skill computers use to detect what is different.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children classify objects and notice which one does not belong.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child circles the odd one out.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil/crayon. Optional: a tray of objects where one does not belong, to find by hand first.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: point to ● ● ● ▲. 'Three are circles. Which one is different?' Circle the triangle.
2. GUIDED: do Exercise 1 together — three stars and one circle; circle the circle.
3. YOU TRY: children do Exercise 2 (the triangle), then Exercise 3 (the star) on their own.
4. Connect: 'Computers spot the odd one too — like finding the one photo that does not match.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — ● ● ● ▲ → circle the ▲.

Ex 1 — ★ ★ ● ★ → circle the ● (circle).

Ex 2 — ■ ▲ ■ ■ → circle the ▲ (triangle).

Ex 3 — ● ● ★ ● ● → circle the ★ (star).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: circling a shape just because it is at the end — ask 'how is it different?'

Simplify: start with two same + one different before four-card groups.

Extend: ask the child to say WHY it does not belong (it is a triangle, the rest are circles).

Movement option: stand three children doing the same action and one doing a different one — who is the odd one out?

Success looks like

The child circles the single odd item in each group and can say what makes the others the same.